



4 Use a larger bristle brush to block in the color of the armchair and the wall behind. The broken color of the background must be cool and subdued so that it does not detract from the main subject. Take time to clean your brushes thoroughly before you apply each new color – working at this speed, you should guard against mistakes such as muddying your colors. Take the paint up to the edge of each separate area of color without overpainting.

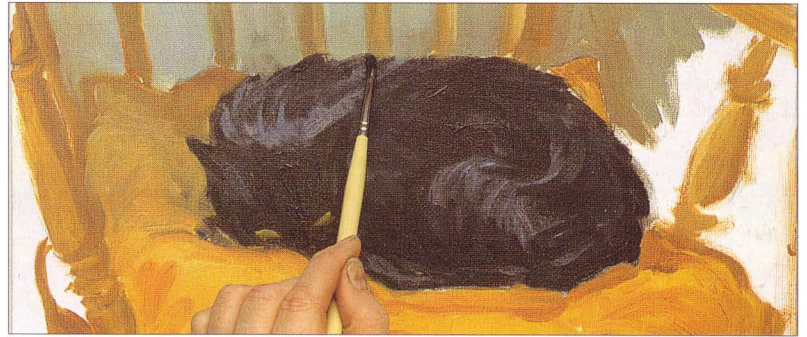
Materials

No.2 round sable brush

No.1 round bristle brush

No.5 long filbert bristle brush

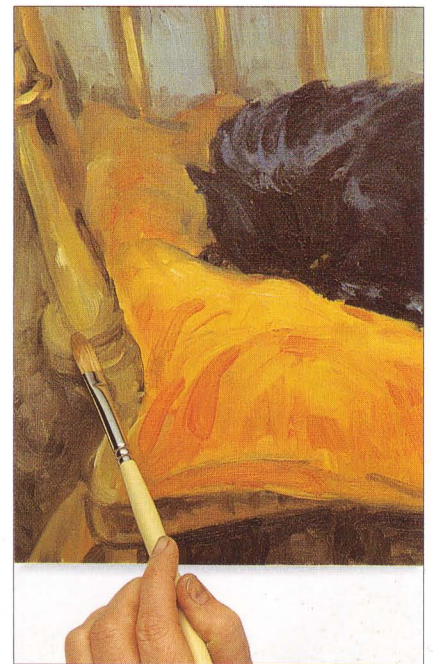
5 Any gaps showing through in the canvas between broad areas of color can be covered up using a small bristle brush. Here the gaps can be covered by emphasizing the cat's wispy fur. Stroke touches of pure Cerulean Blue lightly over the first colors to give rich texture and definition to the cat.



6 Take a fine brush, such as a No.2 round sable, to deepen the shadows on the cat. Using a sable brush should allow you to apply fresh color over a layer of wet paint if you want to avoid mixing the two. Mix a small amount of Cerulean Blue paint with the Ivory Black to keep the shadows cool.



7 Work up the remaining areas of the composition once you are satisfied with the look of the cat. Deepen the folds and shadows of the cushion with pure Cadmium Orange. Use simple tonal variations of Yellow Ochre and Burnt Sienna to mold the wooden armchair.



Cat on an Orange Cushion

This work has been planned in advance so that colors can be placed exactly without becoming muddy. The progress of the work has been geared around a subject that could move at any moment, without compromising the characteristic sense of immediacy associated with this style.

A strong composition is important if you are working quickly from life.

Colors are kept clean and pure, with simple variations in tone.

Sue Sareen